

GRAVE-M Protocol: Master Dataset

Codebook v 2.0

Last Updated: January 7, 2026
Dataset Version: v3 (Final)

1. Identification Variables

Variable	Source	Description
COWcode	Correlates of War	Unique country identifier (Numeric). Standardized across all sources using countrycode package.
year	Various	Observation year (1946–2024). <i>Note: Expanded from v1.1 to cover post-WWII era.</i>

2. Economic & Inequality Indicators

Variable	Source	Description
unified_gdp_pc	WDI / Maddison	Unified Real GDP per Capita. Prioritizes World Development Indicators (WDI) data (Constant 2017 PPP \$). If WDI is missing (mostly historical pre-1990 data), fills gaps using Maddison Project Database (2011 \$).
log_gdp_pc	Calculated	Natural log of unified_gdp_pc. Used to normalize the distribution for regression analysis.
unified_pop	WDI / Maddison	Unified Population.

		Prioritizes WDI data. Fills historical gaps with Maddison Project population data.
log_pop	Calculated	Natural log of unified_pop.
resource_rents	WDI	Total Natural Resources Rents (% of GDP). Sum of oil, natural gas, coal, mineral, and forest rents. Source Code: NY.GDP.TOTL.RT.ZS.
is_petro_state	Ross / WDI	Petro-State Dummy. Binary variable (1 = Petro-state, 0 = Non-petro-state). Logic: 1. Checks Ross Oil & Gas dataset: If Value Per Capita > \$100 (2014\$), coded as 1. 2. Fallback: If Ross is missing, checks WDI resource_rents. If > 10% of GDP, coded as 1. 3. Otherwise 0.
log_oil_gas_wealth	Ross	Log Oil/Gas Wealth. Natural log of (Ross Oil & Gas Value per Capita + 1). Original unit: Constant 2014 US Dollars. Source: Ross & Mahdavi (2015).
gini_disp	SWIID	Gini Coefficient (Disposable Income). Estimate of income inequality after taxes and

		transfers. Source: Standardized World Income Inequality Database (Solt).
fraser_bmp_score	Fraser Institute	Black Market Premium. Measures the gap between the black market exchange rate and the official exchange rate. A proxy for economic distortion and state capacity.

3. Governance & Political Economy

Variable	Source	Description
unified_corruption	V-Dem / WGI	Unified Corruption Index. Measures the extent of political corruption. Logic: 1. Priority: Uses V-Dem Political Corruption Index (v2x_corr) as the primary source (consistent 1946–2024). 2. Fallback: If V-Dem is missing, uses inverted World Governance Indicators (WGI) Control of Corruption. Scale: 0 (Clean) to 1 (Highly Corrupt).
corruption_control	WGI	<i>Deprecated in v3 modeling in favor of unified_corruption.</i> Control of Corruption (Raw WGI).

govt_effectiveness	WGI	Government Effectiveness. Captures perceptions of the quality of public services, civil service independence, and policy formulation. Scale: -2.5 (weak) to 2.5 (strong).
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4. Regime, Episodes & Democracy (V-Dem v15 & ERT)

Variable	Source	Description
is_aut_episode	ERT	Autocratization Episode Dummy. Binary variable (1 = Active Episode, 0 = No Episode). Derived from ERT structural breaks; replaces raw episode IDs to fix missingness.
is_dem_episode	ERT	Democratization Episode Dummy. Binary variable (1 = Active Episode, 0 = No Episode).
v2x_polyarchy	V-Dem	Electoral Democracy Index. The core V-Dem index measuring the extent to which the ideal of electoral democracy is achieved. Scale: 0 (Low) to 1 (High).
v2x_libdem	V-Dem	Liberal Democracy Index. Measures the quality of elections plus the protection of individual liberties and checks and balances. Scale: 0 to 1.
v2x_partipdem	V-Dem	Participatory Democracy

		Index. Emphasizes active participation by citizens in all political processes.
v2x_neopat	V-Dem	Neopatrimonialism Index. Measures the extent to which the state apparatus is used for private gain (clientelism, corruption).
v2x_rule	V-Dem	Rule of Law Index. Measures transparency and equality of law enforcement.
v2exl_legitideol	V-Dem	Ideological Legitimation. To what extent does the leader justify their rule using ideology?

5. Conflict & Security (MIDS v4.0 & ATOP v5.1)

Variable	Source	Description
mid_onset	MIDS	Conflict Onset. Binary variable indicating the start of a Militarized Interstate Dispute in a given year.
fatality	MIDS	Fatality Level. Categorical variable indicating the level of fatalities in the dispute (0=None to 6=>999 deaths).
atop_defense_total	ATOP	Defense Pacts. Count of active defense treaties obliging signatories to intervene militarily if a partner is attacked.

atop_offense_total	ATOP	Offense Pacts. Count of active offense treaties obliging active military cooperation in aggressive action.
atop_defense_with_auto	ATOP / V-Dem	Autocratic Defense Pacts. Count of defense pacts specifically with Autocratic partners (v2x_libdem < 0.5).

6. Leader Ideology (GLI)

Source: Herre (2022, 2023) - Identifying Ideologues

Variable	Source	Description
gli_leader_ideology_num	GLI	Leader Ideology (Numeric). 1 = Leftist, 2 = Centrist, 3 = Rightist, 0 = Missing/None.
leader_ideology_raw	GLI	Leader Ideology (Raw). Original string classification (Leftist, Centrist, Rightist).
is_leftist_leader	GLI	Leftist Dummy. Binary variable (1 if Leftist).
is_rightist_leader	GLI	Rightist Dummy. Binary variable (1 if Rightist).
hog_ideology_raw	GLI	Head of Govt Ideology. Classification for the Head of Government (if different from Head of State).

7. International Relations & Trade (RED & ALBA)

Variable	Source	Description
alba_member	ALBA	ALBA Membership. Binary variable indicating membership in the Bolivarian Alliance.
exp_dep_usa	RED	Export Dependency (USA). Share of total exports going to the USA.
exp_dep_china	RED	Export Dependency (China). Share of total exports going to China.
exp_dep_venezuela	RED	Export Dependency (Venezuela). Share of total exports going to Venezuela.
trade_export_hhi	RED	Export Concentration (HHI). Herfindahl-Hirschman Index of export portfolio concentration.